



Superhero baiting

A study by McAfee has revealed that cybercriminals are using superheroes like Superman and Aquaman to unleash malware

Journey to Mars

Scientists at Imperial College London propose a spinning ship with artificial gravity to get to Mars. <http://dgit.in/MarsTravel>

ASUS AIO Transformer

ASUS's vision of a new world

The ASUS AIO Transformer is a very confused, if interesting device. When you buy the Transformer, what you're getting is an 18" android tablet and an Intel Core i5 powered PC. The two can function separately, the latter with an external display, and the tablet can also function as a remote display for your PC. To break it down, there are three modes of operation:

- 18" Android tablet
- 18" Remote display for the base station
- A PC.

The inner workings are very simple. The tablet acts as a display for your PC when it is plugged into the AIO's dock and acts as a remote



display for your PC using Windows Remote Desktop and a remote-viewer app on the tablet. It's an intelligent use of an already existing technology and it's a wonder that there aren't more people using the system. Of course, you do need a very fast Wi-Fi network to be able to stream your desktop with ease. We faced a lot of lag when we used a 150N router and it was only with a 300N router that we managed to get performance that was close to real-time. If you're just browsing, some lag is OK, but streaming movies is impossible without sufficient bandwidth.

The tablet part of this AIO is an 18" Android tablet running JellyBean on an Nvidia Tegra 3 SoC. With such beefy hardware we expected the system's performance to be excellent, but it wasn't so great. Android benchmarks put this tablet way ahead of most of the competition, Tegra 3 is no slouch after all, but for whatever reason, the interface did lag a bit and it was only in games and certain apps that

we actually felt the power of the device. We were also disappointed at the lack of proper USB ports on a tablet of this size.

The remote desktop mode works well enough, but it's really only good enough for a bit of browsing.

When you consider the PC aspect of the AIO, there isn't that much to say. As you can see from the specs, the PC isn't very powerful and connectivity is an issue as you only have four USB ports on the left side, but thankfully, they're USB 3.0 ports.

At this price point, what you get is an average PC with limited connectivity and a massive tablet that does double duty as a monitor and an Android tablet. The keyboard and mouse are well-designed, but a little frustrating to use and the kind of person who would want such a device would be really rare. This sort of device has a very niche use case and only someone who needs it will find it useful.

We really must commend ASUS for at least trying something new, but we don't feel they've taken the right path. Even something like a Windows 8 PRO tablet with a base station would have been a better deal and it would definitely have been a more functional and seamless experience.

Anirudh Regidi

Edimax BR-6478AC

An inexpensive AC router



The Edimax BR-6478AC is a basic dual band 802.11 AC offering. It's only capable of 867Mbps on the 5GHz band, theoretically. The router is designed well, but sadly has no USB port at all. The average throughput it provided was 45 Mbps in Zone 3. Speaking of signal strength, its performance drops substantially in Zone 4. Except that, everything else works in favour of the BR-6478AC especially the price, as it's almost twice as cheap as other full blown AC routers and is a decent product to go for if you really need the newer and faster wireless 802.11 AC standard.



Features59
Performance.....73
Build Quality.....76
Value for money.....78

Specifications

Dimensions: 196mm x 114mm x 36mm; **Ports:** 1x WAN, 4 x LAN; **Wireless connectivity:** 802.11a/b/g/n/ac; **Operating Frequency:** 2.4GHz at 300 Mbps, 5GHz at 867Mbps; **Encryption:** 64/128-bit WEP, WPA and WPA2 security; **Warranty:** 3 years

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Features65
Performance.....80
Build Quality.....80
Value for money.....55

Specifications

PC: Intel Core i5 3350P; NVIDIA GT730M; 4GB DDR3 RAM; 1TB HDD; 802.11 a/b/g/n Bluetooth V4.0 support; 1GBps LAN; 2x3W speakers; 4xUSB3.0 + 1xUSB2.0 ports; 3-in-1 card reader; Warranty: 3 years
Tablet: 18.4" Full HD, LED IPS display; NVIDIA Tegra 3 SoC; 2GB DDR3 RAM; 32GB eMMC Flash; 802.11 a/b/g/n Bluetooth V3.0; Camera 1.0 MP; 2x1.5W speakers; Docking port; MicroSD card reader; Mini USB port; Kensington lock;

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